



SCSS inheritance

Overview

Managing SCSS assets in Odoo is not as straightforward as it is in some other environments, but it's highly efficient.

Modularity is key. The inheritance scheme described further allows Odoo to:

- customize the Bootstrap CSS framework;
- handle two different webclient designs (Community and Enterprise);
- handle backend and frontend bundles separately (including the user's website design);
- contextually load only necessary assets;
- handle multiple color-schemes (e.g.: dark-mode);

SCSS's `!default` directive

"Direct variables' overrides" are technically possible in SCSS but may lead to inconsistent results in complex environments like Odoo.

Example

library.scss

```
$foo: red;
```

customization_layer.scss

```
$foo: blue; // -> Don't!
```

Indeed, since the compilation process acts across different interdependent bundles, re-assigning a variable in the "wrong spot" may lead to unexpected cascading results.

SCSS provides several techniques to overcome these issues (e.g.: [shadowing](#)), but the most critical procedure in Odoo is the use of the `!default` flag.

loading order.

Example

customization_layer.scss

```
$foo: red !default;
```

library.scss

```
$foo: blue !default; // -> Already defined, line ignored.
$bar: black !default; // -> Not defined yet, value assigned
```

component.scss

```
.component {
  color: $foo; // -> 'color: red;'
  background: $bar; // -> 'background: black;'
}
```

See also

`!default` flag on the [SASS Documentation](#)

Odoo's SCSS inheritance system

The following diagram conceptually illustrates the compilation order in which the CSS and SCSS variables are defined.

```
↓ [Compilation starts]
|
↓ web.dark_mode_variables
|   ├── Primary Variables
|   └── Components Variables
```

```

├─ Primary Variables (community)
├─ Components Variables (community)

↓ web._assets_bootstrap

↓ web.assets_backend
├─ ...
├─ CSS variables definition
├─ CSS variables contextual adaptations

• [Visual result on screen]
```

Important

This diagram is incomplete and does not match the current bundles' organization. Read more on [asset bundles](#).

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